

TEXT OF TELEGRAM 86BUCHAR007545

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PAGE 01 BUCAR 07545 161520Z
ACTION EUR-00

INFO LOG-00 COPY-01 ADS-00 INR-10 SS-00 DIC-02 CIAE-00
CODE-00 H-01 IO-19 NSCE-00 NSAE-00 SSD-00 L-03
TRSE-00 FM-10 PA-02 OMB-01 INRE-03 ACDA-12 SCSC-04
SP-02 SNP-01 PRS-01 SARN-01 SDEL-01 SART-01 /074 W
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FM AMEMBASSY BUCHAREST
TO SECSTATE WASHDC IMMEDIATE 1783
INFO USIA WASHDC IMMEDIATE 5880
EASTERN EUROPEAN POSTS

UNCLAS BUCHAREST 07545

E.O. 12958: N/A
TAGS: PARM, OR, JS
SUBJECT: SHEVARDNADZE OCTOBER 16 PRESS CONFERENCE

1. SUMMARY: SOVIET FOREIGN MINISTER SHEVARDNADZE, SPEAKING TO PRESS IN BUCHAREST AT CONCLUSION OF HIS BILATERAL AND WARSAW PACT MEETINGS HERE, TOOK A TOUGH LINE ON REYKJAVIK IN HIS INITIAL STATEMENT BUT REFLECTED A MUCH MORE OPTIMISTIC VIEW IN HIS ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS. END SUMMARY.

2. IN HIS INITIAL PREPARED STATEMENT, SHEVARDNADZE WAS CRITICAL OF U.S. HANDLING OF THE MEDIA AFTER THE REYKJAVIK MEETING, STATING THAT THE AMERICAN NEWS ELECTRONICS AND OUR "MISREPRESENTATIONS" GAVE A FALSE PICTURE OF WHAT TOOK PLACE AT REYKJAVIK. HE ACCUSED THE U.S. OF WISHING TO LAUNCH A "NEW ARMS RACE" AND SAID IT WAS HARD TO AVOID BEING BITTER AT THE APPARENT U.S. DESIRE TO SHIFT THE ARMS RACE FROM ONE TYPE OF WEAPON TO ANOTHER. HE ACCUSED THE UNITED STATES OF SEEKING TO HAVE THE TWO SUPERPOWERS CONTROL THE WORLD.

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PAGE 02 BUCAR 07545 161520Z

3. IN THE QUESTION AND ANSWER PERIOD, HOWEVER, SHEVARDNADZE REFERRED TO REYKJAVIK AS AN "HISTORIC STEP" WHICH HAD SHOWN "IMMENSE PROGRESS." HE STATED THAT GENEVA SHOULD TAKE UP WHERE REYKJAVIK LEFT OFF, AND HE NOTED THAT SDI IS THE MAIN OBSTACLE TO PROGRESS ON ARMS CONTROL. KIRK

DEPARTMENT OF STATE A/CDC/MR

REVIEWED by SPA DATE 11/14/89
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FOI, EO or PA exemptions

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